

Daily Market Summary

July 21, 2026

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: **+0.24** → **Slightly Bullish**

Trend (5-day EMA): **-0.01** → **Neutral** — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	+0.45
News headlines	20%	-0.27
Reddit (disabled)	0%	+0.09
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	-0.17

Equities rose with Nasdaq +1.9%, S&P 500 +0.9%, VIX -8.6%. Sector breadth: 7/11 sectors up. 10Y yield +0.7%. News headlines read slightly bearish. Fed-policy expectations tightened (13-Week T-Bill Yield +2.5bp). Today's overall market tone: Slightly Bullish. (news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

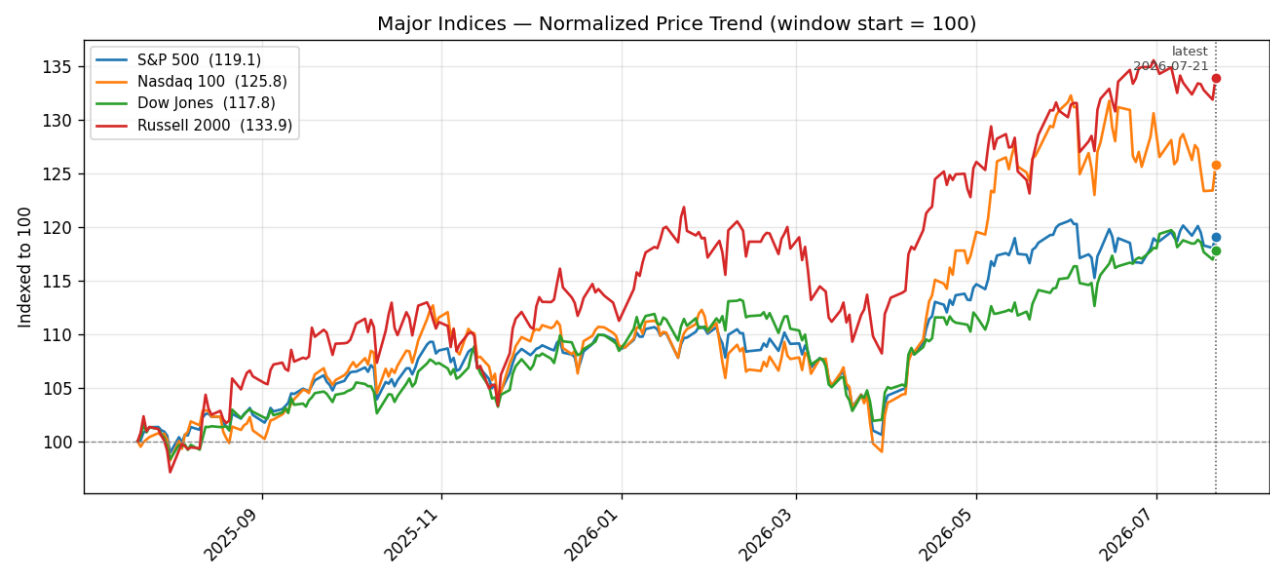
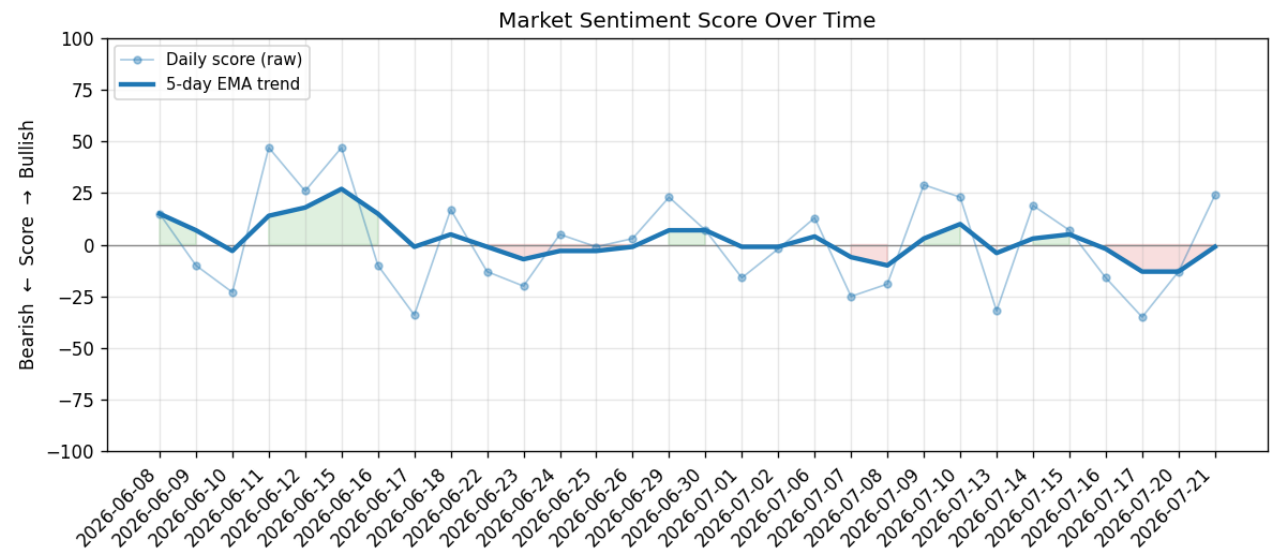
Most bullish (+0.69) — Goldman Sachs to Create Private Market Platform for Rich Investors

Most bearish (-0.64) — As the U.S.-Iran war heats up again, these parts of the stock market and economy could be affected

Divergence Alert

■■ Divergence: prices rose but the news mood is negative — the tape is climbing a wall of worry.

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	+12.34%	+10.41% vs Nasdaq	38%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.78)
Networking / Interconnect	+6.68%	+4.75% vs Nasdaq	36%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.78)
Semiconductors / Compute	+6.12%	+4.19% vs Nasdaq	30%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.77)
Banking	+1.75%	+0.86% vs S&P	81%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.70)
Pharma / Healthcare	+1.18%	+0.29% vs S&P	81%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.57)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	-0.32%	-2.25% vs Nasdaq	29%	Slightly Bullish	Slightly Bearish (-0.28)
Consumer	-0.75%	-1.64% vs S&P	31%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.46)
SaaS	-2.52%	-4.45% vs Nasdaq	67%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.76)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Flt	Day	Today's Read
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	1.87	5.3%	+12.34%	Bullish — short-squeeze rebound — shorts/puts were loaded into the selloff and fueled the rip
Banking	1.74	0.0%	+1.76%	Bullish — advance, but heavily hedged — protection still bid
Pharma / Healthcare	1.26	1.7%	+1.18%	Bullish — advance, but heavily hedged — protection still bid
Semiconductors / Compute	0.98	2.5%	+6.11%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Networking / Interconnect	0.79	4.3%	+6.68%	Bullish — short-squeeze rebound — shorts/puts were loaded into the selloff and fueled the rip

Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.65	1.6%	-0.32%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Consumer	0.63	1.9%	-0.75%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
SaaS	0.61	5.5%	-2.52%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
All tracked	0.97	2.4%	+1.41%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
Aehr Test Systems (AEHR)	98.91	+27.86%
Regencell Bioscience Holdings L (RGC)	6.06	+18.82%
Nebius Group N.V. (NBIS)	216.92	+18.78%
Cerebras Systems Inc. (CBRS)	208.57	+17.92%
Ouster, Inc. (OUST)	40.68	+17.00%

Top News

Why Micron and other chip stocks are bouncing back so strongly — MarketWatch (Top)

The recent chip sell-off presented a buying opportunity, and open-source AI models should drive more memory demand, analysts say

As the U.S.-Iran war heats up again, these parts of the stock market and economy could be affected — CNBC (Finance)

Investors and economists are deliberating what the latest exchange in hostilities will mean for the broader economy.

US senator urges Wall Street to reject offer of paid early access to Trump posts — Investing.com

Forget Nvidia. These 5 S&P 500 stocks are quietly going all in on AI. — MarketWatch (Top)

The “Mag Seven” has become the “Bag Seven.” Sharp tech investors are looking elsewhere.

Jamie Dimon says markets underestimate risks and he wouldn't buy stocks or Treasurys at current prices — CNBC (Finance)

Comments from JPMorgan Chase CEO Jamie Dimon contrast with investors' recent willingness to look past wars, tariffs and other shocks.

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,509.20	+65.92	+0.89%
Nasdaq 100	29,155.18	+550.95	+1.93%
Dow Jones	52,224.64	+385.38	+0.74%
Russell 2000	2,987.40	+44.97	+1.53%
VIX	17.05	-1.60	-8.58%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	207.29	+4.01	+1.97%
Microsoft	397.75	-4.54	-1.13%
AMD	544.43	+40.86	+8.11%
Meta	643.81	-2.04	-0.32%
Alphabet	346.19	-5.18	-1.47%
Broadcom	386.50	+8.34	+2.21%
Micron	970.82	+105.36	+12.17%
Intel	105.45	+8.39	+8.64%
SanDisk	1,589.40	+198.45	+14.27%
Coherent	317.22	+31.82	+11.15%
Amazon	247.55	-2.44	-0.98%
Apple	327.74	+1.15	+0.35%
Arm	289.73	+20.12	+7.46%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,082.20	+66.30	+1.65%
Crude Oil	84.54	+2.06	+2.50%
Bitcoin	66,283.04	+1,041.34	+1.60%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.14	-0.00	-0.10%
USD/JPY	163.15	+0.70	+0.43%
GBP/USD	1.34	-0.00	-0.36%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.63	+0.03	+0.65%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.73	+0.03	+0.67%

Analyst Summary

Semiconductor Rally Powers Markets Higher

U.S. equities rallied broadly on Tuesday, with the Nasdaq 100 surging 1.93% as semiconductor stocks staged a powerful rebound. The S&P 500 added 0.89% and the Dow rose 0.74%, while the VIX tumbled 8.58% to 17.05, reflecting diminished hedging demand. The tech-heavy rally was driven by renewed optimism around memory chips and AI infrastructure, with several semiconductor names posting double-digit gains.

Memory Chips Lead Explosive Sector Rotation

The memory sector exploded higher, up 12.34%, fueled by reports of persistent supply constraints. **Micron** surged 12.17% and **SanDisk** rocketed 14.27%, leading the charge. Market chatter focused on comments from ADATA's chairman warning that DRAM shortages could persist for another decade, supporting bullish sentiment across the memory complex. MarketWatch highlighted the chip sector's strong bounce, while positioning data revealed a classic short-squeeze dynamic—puts and shorts accumulated into the recent selloff amplified today's rally.

Intel (+8.64%), **AMD** (+8.11%), and **Coherent** (+11.15%) also posted impressive gains, while networking stocks rallied 6.68%. The semiconductor and compute sector advanced 6.12%, significantly outpacing the broader Nasdaq. Nvidia added 2.0% and Arm climbed 7.5%, though Broadcom's more modest 2.2% gain suggested selectivity within the chip complex.

Mega-Cap Tech Mixed as Rotation Intensifies

In contrast to the semiconductor surge, several mega-cap internet names lagged. **Alphabet** fell 1.47%, **Microsoft** declined 1.13%, and **Amazon** shed nearly 1%, while the hyperscaler/neocloud sector dipped 0.32%. The SaaS sector underperformed sharply, down 2.52%, though breadth remained relatively healthy. This divergence suggests investors rotated from software and cloud platforms into hardware and chip infrastructure.

Risk Assets Broadly Firmer

Commodities rallied alongside equities, with **gold** up 1.65% to \$4,082 and **crude oil** jumping 2.5% to \$84.54 amid reports of escalating U.S.-Iran tensions. **Bitcoin** gained 1.6% to \$66,283. The 10-year Treasury yield rose 3 basis points to 4.63%, consistent with the risk-on tone. Banking stocks climbed 1.75%, while pharma/healthcare advanced 1.18%, both outpacing the S&P 500.

Macro Backdrop and Caution

Despite the strong rally, JPMorgan CEO Jamie Dimon warned that markets underestimate current risks, stating he wouldn't buy stocks or Treasuries at prevailing prices. Nonetheless, positioning data suggests the advance was driven by short covering and unwinding of hedges rather than panic, with overall put/call ratios near neutral at 0.97.